

HAWTHORNE EMPOWERMENT COALITION

Community
Meeting
6/26/2025

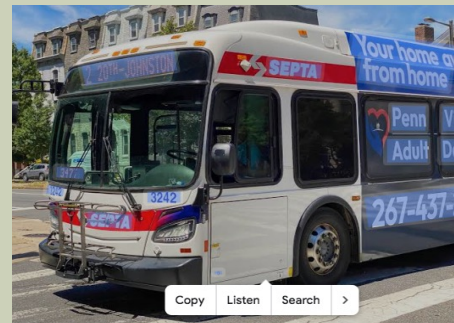


INTERIM BOARD

- Co-Presidents: Daphne Watkins and Greg LaBier
- Co-Vice Presidents: Gwendolyn Toler and Judith Thomas
- Treasurer: Ann Lastuvka
- Recording Secretary: Valerie King
- Correspondence Secretary: Jacob Goldfischer
- Communications Chair: John Kehayias
- Arts Committee Chair: Kelly Korzun
- Education Committee Chair: Gabby Thomas
- Zoning Committee Chair: Ann Lastuvka

AGENDA

- Financial Report
- Bylaws
- Hawthorne Tree Cover Initiative
- Arts Committee Update
- Upcoming Events
- Zoning Committee Update
- Guest Speaker: Aaron Davis from Representative Waxman's Office will give update on SEPTA Funding Situation



FINANCIAL REPORT

- We have now gained access to HEC's Bank Account from previous board president as of 6/20/2025.

- Cash Position as of 6/25/2025
 - Checking: \$10,283.34
 - Escrow: \$63,256.30

- Recent Expenses in Last Month:
 - 1. Renewed HEC's contract with ACAM (street cleaning services). \$1230 Weekly. Paid \$6,150 on 5/29/2025.
 - 2. \$10,000 (?) recently paid to recreation center for Ridgeway Park Improvements (paid out previously on 5/27/2025 by prior board president)
 - 3. Community Organizer: Stan Horowitz.

FINANCIAL REPORT

■ Income YTD

- No income has been brought in this year so far, but we are owed \$65,000 from Post Brothers and Benchmark, with new bank access and Quickbooks, will send invoices shortly.

■ Expenses YTD: \$38,278.16

- Charitable Disbursements: \$31,200
 - Academic Scholarships: \$3,000
 - Sidewalk Sweeping: \$6,200
 - Jazz in the Park: \$7,000
 - Fanny Jackson Auditorium Improvements: \$5,000
 - Ridgeway Park Improvements: \$10,000
- Community Organizer: \$2,500
- Directors and Officers Liability Insurance: \$655
- Community Meeting Mailings: \$4,000

OTHER UPDATES

- RCO Registration with Philadelphia City Planning Commission: June 1st – June 30th. To be done this week.
- P.O. Box has now been set up.
- Completed annual report to the state.
- In process of renewing our RCO status
- Daphne Watkins and Ann Lastuvka attended Crosstown Coalition's Annual Meeting.

BYLAWS

- We need updated bylaws. This should be a priority for our RCO.
- Should be a collaborative effort between interim board and community members.
- Previous Bylaws are from 2002.
- Previous Bylaws had two voting members ->
 - 1. An attending member is a voting member who has attended at least 5 general meetings within a year and is eligible to vote on all community issues, in the annual election and on financial matters of HEC.
 - 2. A general member is a voting member eligible to vote on all community issues.
 - 3. Also had 5 different membership classes (Individual, Seniors/Disabled, Individual Patron, Small Business, Medium Business, Large Business)

BYLAWS

- Quorum: A quorum at any given meeting of the membership shall consist of one-half of members; either present or represented by written proxy.
- The boundaries of the Hawthorne Community -> are defined as area inclusive from 11th Street to Broad Street and from South Street to Washington Avenue

BYLAWS

■ Proposed Changes (Up for Discussion)

- 1. Simplify voting members into one group. Requirements are proof of address within Hawthorne Community Boundaries and attendance of at least 3 community meetings in past 12 months.
- 2. Quorum shall consist of majority of voting members in attendance at any community meeting.
- 3. Remove membership classes

HAWTHORNE TREE COVER INITIATIVE

- **Goal: Increase Tree Cover in Hawthorne Neighborhood**
 - **Benefits:** Studies highlight the role of trees in mitigating urban heat island effect, improving air quality, reducing storm-water runoff, and providing habitat for wildlife.
 - Philadelphia has a goal to increase tree canopy cover to 30% by 2025
- **Meeting was held on 6/5/2026 with HEC Co-President Greg LaBier and Louis Bartholomew from QVNA (Queen Village Neighbors Association)**
- **Two planting seasons for city trees: November and April. We will be preparing for next April season as application windows have already closed for November.**

HAWTHORNE TREE COVER INITIATIVE

- Need door to door volunteers to help homeowners fill out tree applications.
- Philadelphia Horticultural Society ->
<https://phsonline.org/programs/tree-programs/get-a-tree>
- New trees need weekly watering for 6 months after planting. They require ~10 gallons of water a week. Would be cost to homeowner for initial 6 months. We could explore HEC subsidy to homeowners to cover water costs for first 6 months.
- First year goal: 10-20 neighbors

HAWTHORNE TREE COVER INITIATIVE

- First locations to target: Empty Tree Wells



HAWTHORNE TREE COVER INITIATIVE

- Dead tree and stump removals. Need to contact city.



COMMITTEE UPDATES

- **Arts Committee:** The 1001 S Broad St. Art Installation and Opening Event, featuring local artists from our community and schools, is unfortunately postponed due to a temporary budget issue with buildings developers. The Arts Committee chaired by Kelly Korzun has been working hard for this event, but unfortunately is still awaiting the sidewalk to be finished. We will have an update soon.
- **Zoning Committee:** There are now HEC Zoning meetings for June or July. Meetings are being scheduled for August and September
 - **Upcoming Developments:** 1101 Catherine Street

EVENTS

- Jazz at Hawthorne Park -> Tonight! Featuring vocalist Kevin Velentine at 7PM
- Movies in Hawthorne Park
 - Friday, August 22nd at 7:45PM. Moana 2.
 - Friday, July 18th at 8:30PM. Wicked.

GUEST SPEAKER

- Aaron Davis – SEPTA Update